



No. 2388—Estab. 1851.

DUNEDIN, N.Z.: THURSDAY, DECEMBER 7, 1899.

[PRICE SIXPENCE.]

Public Notices.

SHAW, SAVILL, AND ALBION COMPANY (LIMITED).
FOR LONDON.—ROYAL MAIL STEAMERS, with Superior Accommodation for all Classes of Passengers, calling at Monte Video or Rio de Janeiro, Tenerife, and Plymouth.

S.S.	Tons.	Com-mander.	From	Date.
GOTHIC	7730	Kidley	Wellington	1899.
DELPHIC	8273	Sowden	—	Dec. 7
—	—	—	—	1900.
AOEA	6346	Evans	Wellington	Jan.
IONIC	4753	Kempson	Wellington	March 1

CARGO STEAMERS.

TOKOMARU	6238	Maxwell	Wellington	Dec. 14
MAMARI	3533	—	—	Dec.
MATATUA	3322	Holmes	—	Dec.
PAKHA	4331	Prosser	—	Feb.
KANGATIRA	4045	Nicole	—	Feb.
MAORI	5809	Moffatt	—	March
WAIWERA	6206	Stuart	—	—

Passengers forwarded from Dunedin to Port of Departure of Mail Steamer FREE.
Special facilities are afforded for bringing out friends and relatives from Home by issue of passage orders in the colony.

For freight or passage apply to the Agents:
NATIONAL MORTGAGE & AGENCY COMPANY OF N.Z. (LIMITED),
MURRAY, ROBERTS, AND CO
DALGETY & COMPANY LIMITED.

THE NEW ZEALAND SHIPPING COMPANY'S LINE.

FOR LONDON, calling at MONTE VIDEO, TENERIFFE, and PLYMOUTH.

S.S. WAKANUI,

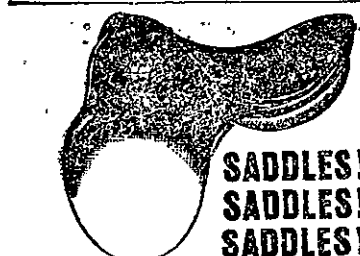
5706 tons register.
Will be despatched as above from WEL-
LINGTON on or about
THURSDAY, NOVEMBER 20.

TO be followed by the s.s. RAKAIA on
DECEMBER 23.

Coastal Passage to Port of Departure FREE.

Warrants issued for Passages from the
United Kingdom to New Zealand. Through
bookings to West Coast of South America,
Falkland Islands, Bahia, and Pernambuco.

For further particulars apply to
**THE NEW ZEALAND SHIPPING COM-
PANY (LIMITED),**
9 BOND STREET, DUNEDIN.

**SADDLES!
SADDLES!
SADDLES!**

A. MCKENZIE draws attention of RUN-
NERS, HOLDERS, FARMERS, etc., to the
Special Values he is offering in Colonial-made
SADDLERY, especially in SADDLES.
No. 1 turnout consists Stock Saddle,
pigskin seat, single rein bridle ... £2 10
No. 2—Stock Saddle, pigskin seat, lea-
ther girth, double-reined bridle ... £4 0
No. 3—Stock Saddle, pigskin seat, lea-
ther girth, heavy nickel stirrups, double-
reined bridle, nickel bit ... £4 10
No. 4—Stock Saddle, pigskin seat, lea-
ther girth, nickel stirrups, double-
reined bridle, nickel bit ... £5 2
No. 5—Stock Saddle, pigskin seat, lea-
ther girth, heavy nickel irons, best
double-reined bridle, stout nickel bit ... £6 10
Attention Stockriders directed to super. qua-
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On cash orders for £2 and upwards railage
will be paid. Cash orders for £5 upwards de-
livered free in South Island.
Goldfields orders receive special attention.

Note carefully the address: **A. MCKENZIE,
SADDLER, Princess street, Dunedin.**

TRUST MONEY TO LEND
On Freehold Security or Municipal De-
bentures.—£15,000 to Lend in sums of £5000
and under from 4 1/2 per cent. to 5 per cent.
The TRUSTEES, EXECUTORS, & AGENCY
COMPANY OF NEW ZEALAND (LTD.).
28 1/2 W. LAURENCE SIMPSON, Manager.

WANTED KNOWN—Without a doubt
P. L. ER DICK is the most Reliable
Watchmaker. Opposite Coffee Palace, Moray
Place, Dunedin.

Public Notices.

SHIRE LINE DIRECT STEAMERS.
OTAGO TO LONDON.

PERTSHIRE	8000 tons	3500 h.p.
BUTESHIRE	8000 tons	3500 h.p.
BANFESHIRE	8100 tons	3500 h.p.
FIFESHIRE	8500 tons	3500 h.p.
NAIRNSHIRE	8500 tons	3500 h.p.
MORAYSHIRE	8500 tons	3500 h.p.

The above magnificent Steamers, which have
all been specially built for the New Zealand
trade, and make an average passage of 49 days,
will be despatched at regular intervals.
Steamers are fitted throughout with ELEC-
TRIC LIGHT, and accommodation is provided
for Saloon Passengers.

OUR NEXT DEPARTURE FOR LONDON
Will be

NAIRNSHIRE—Captain P. WALLACE—Wel-
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(Calling at Canary Islands).
Doctor and Stewardess carried.
SALOON PASSAGE MONEY, 45 Guineas
OTAGO TO LONDON.
For Plans and further Particulars, &c. apply
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Australian Mutual Provident Buildings,
Princes street, Dunedin.

MESSAGERIES MARITIMES.
SYDNEY TO LONDON, via
COLOMBO AND PARIS.

Steamer.	Sydney.	Melbourne.	Adelaide
	Noon.	1 p.m.	1 p.m.
AUSTRALIEN	Dec. 25	December 28	Dec. 30
VILLE DE LA	—	—	—
CHOTAY	Jan. 22	January 25	Jan. 27
POLYNESIE	Feb. 18	February 21	Feb. 24
ARMAND BEHIC	Mar. 10	March 12	March 14

Steamers of 6500 tons under postal contract
with the French Government, calling at MEL-
BOURNE, ADELAIDE, ALBANY, CO-
LOMBO, SUEZ, and Port Said, will be de-
spatched monthly as follows:—
Passengers booked to BOMBAY, INDIA,
CHINA, BATAVIA, and JAPAN.
PASSAGE MONEY, £25 to £70, including
table wines.

RETURN TICKETS, available for 9 or 12
months, at REDUCED RATES.
ENGLISH SPOKEN ON BOARD.
Passage money can be paid here for passages
from Europe. Liberal concessions to families.
N.B.—Passengers' luggage conveyed free of
cost from Marseilles to London by steamer.
For further particulars apply to
NEILL & CO. (LIMITED),
Dunedin.

**NEW ZEALAND BIBLE, TRACT,
AND
BOOK SOCIETY,**
46 Princes Street, DUNEDIN.

THE STORY OF THE BIBLE, from Genesis
to Revelation, told in simple language,
adapted for all ages, but specially for
children; 620 pages and illustrations,
cloth covers, price 3s 6d; posted, 4s 3d.

**CONFIDENTIAL TALKS ON HOME AND
CHILD LIFE**, by Mrs S. M. I. Henry;
written to help the busy father and
mother; cloth covers, price 3s 6d; posted,
3s 11d.

DANESBURY HOUSE, by Mrs Henry
Wood, £100 prize Temperance Story;
cloth covers (315 pages); 2s; posted, 2s
5d.

SOME ONE, by Joseph Parker, D.D.—
Thoughts concerning Christ and His
truth; written for those desiring some
guidance in Christian inquiry; cloth, 2s
6d; posted, 2s 10d.

**CONFIDENTIAL TALKS WITH YOUNG
MEN**, ditto WITH YOUNG WOMEN.
Two "eminently healthy books," by Ly-
man B. Sperry, M.D. Price 3s 6d each;
posted, 3s 10d.

MAGAZINES and PERIODICALS for 1900.
Orders should be sent in at once, unless
already forwarded. Printed Price Lists
sent on application.

**A New and really good thing in BOOT
WEAR is PARSON'S PATENT TOE
SHIELDS.** Parents and Guardians would
find great advantages in buying boots with
shields attached. The Toes of Boots and
Shoes effectually preserved. Ask your Boot-
dealer for Boots with Parson's Toe Shields
attached, and insist on having them.

Sole Agents for New Zealand:
ALFRED TYREE & CO.,
Christchurch, N.Z.

Wholesale from Boot Manufacturers and
Leather Merchants. Retail from Boot Deal-
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Shields may be obtained by Parents loose
and attached to boots, care being taken to se-
cure right-size shield.

Public Notices.

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CAN'T BE SHIFTED!
First Award New Zealand and South Seas
Exhibition for Colonial-made Saddles and Har-
ness.
My 25 turnout, consisting of a First-class
Saddle (with Mountings Complete, all hand-
made), and Double-reined strong bridle, is the
best value for the money in the Colony.
£4. £4.

I am also making a Lighter Saddle than
above, with Double-reined Saddle Bridle, com-
plete with all mountings, for £4. Inspection in-
vited. Compare quality with prices.

NOTE THE ADDRESS:
P. MILLER,
IMPORTER & MANUFACTURER OF SADDLERY,
8 RATTRAY STREET, DUNEDIN.

**HERBERT,
HAYNES,
AND CO.,**
DUNEDIN.

**CLOTHING ...
DEPARTMENT.**

200 Men's Colonial Saddle Tweed Suits, all
Twisted Yarn, 37s 6d.

100 Men's Colonial Saddle Tweed Suits,
Heavy Make, 42s 6d.

150 Pairs Men's Saddle Tweed Trousers,
12s 6d.

75 Pairs Men's Saddle Tweed Trousers,
Heavy Make, 14s 6d.

The above are made up in First-class
Style, with Best Trimmings, and are recom-
mended for Hard Wear.

50 Men's Drab Covert Coats, special value,
21s.

20 Men's Drab Covert Coats, of best manu-
facture, 30s.

60 Men's Durable Waterproof Coats, 30s.

50 Men's Thoroughly Waterproof Coats,
42s 6d.

30 Men's Very Superior Waterproof Coats,
57s 6d.

TAILORING DEPARTMENT.

SUITS TO MEASURE, made from Good
Strong Tweed, in dark Colours; well
finished, £3 3s.

Double Width Twilled Navy Serge, for boys
School Wear, 3s 11d, 4s 6d, 4s 9d
5s 6d per yard.

Colonial Tweed, suitable for boys' School
Wear, in a grand Range of Patterns,
2s 6d, 2s 9d, 3s 3d, 3s 6d per
yard.

We hold the Largest and Most Reliable Stock
of Men's and Boys' Ready-made Cloth-
ing in Dunedin to select from.

English, Scotch, and Colonial Twee in
Latest Colourings and Designs.

**TAILORING BY THOROUGHLY EX-
PERIENCED HANDS.**

Public Notices.

NEW ANNUALS,

SUITABLE for CHRISTMAS PRESENTS.

	Posted.	s. d.
Boys' Own Annual	9 0	
Girls' Own Annual	9 0	
Chums' (Annual)	10 0	
Sunday at Home	9 0	
Leisure Hour	9 0	
The Quiver	10 0	
Chatterbox	3 6	
Bo-Beep	3 6	
Child's Companion	2 3	

CHRISTMAS NUMBERS.

	s. d.	Posted.
Illustrated London News	1 6	2 0
The Graphic	1 6	2 0
Pears' Annual	1 6	2 0
Black and White	1 6	2 0
Holly Leaves	1 6	2 0
Weekly Press	1 0	1 0
New Zealand Graphic	1 0	1 0

CHRISTMAS & NEW YEAR CARDS.
DIARIES FOR 1900.

ALEX. SLIGO,
42 GEORGE STREET.

**INSOLVENT ESTATE.**

Weadon, Thomas, and Co.,
GUNMAKERS,
CORNER LITTLE COLLINS AND ELIZABETH
STREETS
MELBOURNE.

THE Trustees offer to the public, to clear
the balance of the stock, 8 Double-barrel
Breech-loaders, best barrels, double grip, best
English walnut stocks, best steel locks, with
Cartridge Machines and Cleaners complete—
usual price £7 10s, reduced £2 15s each com-
plete; 6 Double-barrel Breech-loading Guns,
best twist barrels, snap action, best steel locks,
choke bore, well-finished, best English Walnut
stocks, with Cartridge Machines and Cleaners
complete—usual price £10 10s, reduced £3 17s
6d each complete; 7 Double-barrel Breech-
loading Guns, highly finished and all the latest
improvements, extra good quality, with Car-
tridge Machines and Cleaners complete—usual
price £10, reduced £5 10s each complete; 5
Single-barrel Breech-loading Guns, best twist
barrels, English walnut stocks, best steel locks,
with Cartridge Machines and Cleaners com-
plete—usual price £4 15s, reduced £2 5s each
complete; 9 Martini-Henry Action Rifles—
usual price £5 10s, reduced £2 7s 8d each;
Snider Sporting Rifles, very best quality,
highly finished—usual price £5 10s, reduced
£2 5s each; 6 Winchester Repeating Rifles,
very best special quality, highly finished—
usual price £7 10s, reduced £3 15s; 4 Single-
barrel Breech-loading Sporting Rifles, extra
well finished, and splendid weapons—usual
price £3 15s, reduced 32s 6d; 8 Single-barrel
Duck Guns, large size bore, best twist barrel,
walnut stocks, will kill at 150yds, with
Cleaners—usual price £15, reduced £5 5s
each; 4 Hammerless Double-barrel Breech-
loaders, special high-class quality and finish,
in solid Leather Case and Cartridge Machines
and Cleaners complete—our usual price was
£25, reduced to £11 10s each complete; 6
Special Quality Air Rifles, suitable to use in
a parlour or bar, highly finished—usual price
£3, reduced 25s. Darts for Air Rifle, 1s 11d
dozen; Slugs, 3s 6d per 1000. All orders de-
livered free. Carriage paid to any address in
New Zealand or any of the Australian
Colonies. A fair trial given with every gun.
Cartridges can be supplied for the Breech-
loading Guns at 6s 6d per 100 in any size shot.
Bank drafts, cheques, or post office orders
must be made payable to Weadon, Thomas
and Co.

ROBIN & CO. have for sale a Miniature
Victoria; very neat.

ROBIN & CO. have For Sale, a light Phae-
ton; good and cheap.

ROBIN & CO. have For Sale, their much-
sought-after Patent Eureka two-seat
Sulky.

ROBIN & CO. have For Sale, Double and
Single Buggies.

ROBIN & CO. have For Sale, Family Wag-
ons and other Vehicles.

ROBIN & CO. Octagon and Stuart street,
build, repair, and exchange all kinds of
Vehicles.

Public Notices.

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found on Page 32.

CHRISTMAS NUMBERS.
CHRISTMAS NUMBERS.
1899. 1899. 1899.

W. J. PRICOR & CO.,
DUNEDIN.

As usual, we shall have a large supply of
Christmas Numbers and Christmas An-
nals, and as far as we can see the demand
will be as great as ever, so we should be glad
to have your orders in as soon as possible.

PEARS' ANNUAL will contain three Pictures,
the principal one of which is Landseer's
famous picture, "The Shoeing of the Bay
Mare"; the others, "A Daughter of Eve,"
by Edwin Patey, and "Passion Flowers,"
by Miss Murtrie.

ILLUSTRATED LONDON NEWS. The Pic-
ture is entitled "Too Late for School."
BLACK AND WHITE. Two Art-Supplements
—"Cortez," by G. C. Hindley, and "The
Unconverted," by Millet.

THE GENTLEWOMAN. The Art Satin Sup-
plement this year will be the "Princess of
Wales." The best ever issued.

HOLLY LEAVES. The subscribers this
year will be presented with a copy of the
fine War Picture by R. Caton Woodville,
"Up, Guards, and At 'Em."

THE LONDON GRAPHIC. A reproduction
of Sir John Millais's Picture, "The Flood."
THE SKETCH. Two companion Pictures—
"The Belle of the Ball" and "The Belle
of the Ballet."

PRICES FOR CHRISTMAS NUMBERS,
1899.

	Illustrated London News	Christmas	Number	1 6	2 0
Black and White	1 6	2 0			
Sketch	1 6	2 0			
Pears' Annual	1 6	2 0			
Holly Leaves	1 6	2 0			
Gentlewoman	1 6	2 0			
Windsor Magazine	1 6	2 0			
Strand Magazine	1 6	2 0			
Pearson's Magazine	1 6	2 0			
Cassell's Family Magazine	1 0	1 6			
Australasian	0 6	0 6			
Otago Witness	1 0	1 0			
Weekly Press	1 0	1 0			
Auckland Weekly	1 0	1 0			
And others of a similar Published Price at same average.					

It is necessary for us to have orders at an
early date to ensure supply, as
**WE ANTICIPATE AN ENORMOUS
DEMAND.**

All Orders must be accompanied with Re-
mittance.

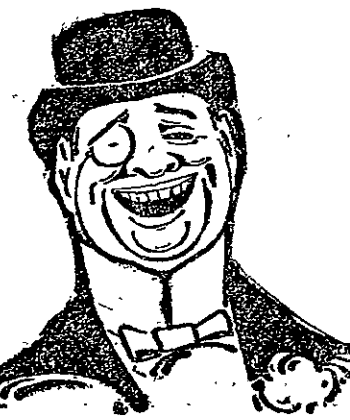
**ALL
PEOPLE
SOUND THE
PRAISES
OF
NELSON
MOATE & CO'S.
PURE CEYLON OR BLENDED
TEAS.**

CLUB HOTEL
(Family and Commercial),
TIMARU
(Close to Railway Station).
ONE SHILLING LUNCHEON
(Including Sparkling Ale) from 12 to 3.
G. SEARLE
(Late Palmerston South),
Proprietor.

A. G. Kidston-Hunter,
**ANALYTICAL AND CONSULTING
CHEMIST,**
**COLONIAL MUTUAL BUILDINGS,
PRINCES STREET.**
Laboratory Open Daily for Private Tuition.
Commercial Analyses and Investigations
Undertaken.

THE MAN WHO LAUGHS

Is the fortunate individual who sleeps soundly, and for whom "good digestion waits on appetite."



Cheerfulness, sound sleep and perfect digestion are always attainable by drinking

WOLFE'S SCHNAPPS

If you have "that tired feeling" about you that makes you depressed and gloomy, caused probably by the liver and kidneys being a little out of gear, try WOLFE'S SCHNAPPS a pleasant tonic beverage.

Ask for WOLFE'S and refuse cheap imitations.

THE SKETCHER.

THE WIND-SWEPT ISLAND OF SAN NICOLAS.

PROFESSOR C. F. HOLDER, in the Scientific American.

About seventy miles off the coast of Southern California lies the island of San Nicolas—a veritable desert, wind-swept to such a degree that one might well imagine the furies are guarding the island. San Nicolas, which is 12 miles long and four or five wide, has no harbours, the anchorage being merely a lee under the low hills; the fact that the wind blows directly offshore making it possible for vessels to anchor here at certain seasons. On this island, which has been the central point of a romance and tragedy of much interest, deserted and alone, Maria Better Than Nothing, the wild woman of San Nicolas, lived 20 years—long enough to forget her people and even her language. The story is as follows:—

For centuries the island was inhabited by a race of hardy mariners who have left their monuments in large shell heaps and mounds that cover many acres. Less than one hundred years ago, the Franciscan fathers determined to take the natives away from the inhospitable island and provide them with homes around the various missions, where they could also be comfortably converted. With this object in view, a vessel was sent to the island, and after much difficulty the Indians, now reduced to about one hundred, were collected and taken aboard, deserting thousands of implements which their ancestors had used for centuries. When the vessel was about to sail, one of the women discovered that her child had been left behind. But it was blowing a gale, and the vessel could not hold, so the captain sailed away, whereupon the frantic mother dashed into the sea and swam back to the shore, making her way successfully through the surf. The captain of the vessel promised to return for the woman, but soon after his vessel was wrecked, and no attempt was made to rescue the poor Indian woman until 20 years after, when a priest determined to make an effort to learn whether she was alive. He enlisted the services of an otter hunter and several Indians, who in a small schooner, known as Better Than Nothing, set sail for San Nicolas.

They landed on the island, and very soon found evidence that some one was living there, but avoiding them. To make the search perfect, the men formed a line across the island at certain distances apart, which resulted in the discovery of the wild woman. She was sitting by a brush hut in a canyon, about which was a windbreak of the whalebones and various material. She smiled and spoke to the Indians in a language they did not understand; but they fell on their faces before her as though to worship her. She offered them food, and readily consented to go with them, and was taken aboard the schooner with a tame otter. She was dressed in the skins of birds, over which was a garment of seal-skin. She was named Better Than Nothing, after the vessel, and by signs succeeded in telling some Indians on the mainland something of her history. At first she had mourned the loss of her friends; then the dogs killed her baby, and she wished to die and was sick for a long time. She was taken to Santa Barbara, where Indians from all about were brought to her to see if they could understand her language, but without avail. She lived with different families at Santa Barbara; but civilisation proved disastrous to her, and in less than three months she died. Her remarkable dress of feathers was sent to Rome as a curiosity, and the remains of the unfortunate woman found a resting-place in the sanctified ground of the mission.

San Nicolas has proved a veritable trea-

sure-house for the archaeologist, and tons of stone implements have been taken from various mounds on the island. One of the most remarkable shell mounds in the world is found here, being, it is said, nearly a mile long and ten feet in average height. On its wind-swept surface innumerable objects have been found, exposed during previous hurricanes, with the bodies of Indians facing each other, having been buried in a sitting position, with hands clasped over the head. With many remains were buried such personal effects as mortars, ollas, flutes, jewel boxes, charms, flint spear-heads, and almost every article needed by a hunting and fishing people—all formed from shell, bone, or wood. Fishing lines were made of kelp; sinkers of stone with a groove worn around or a hole in the centre; the hook was of elegant design, and bore the barb upon the outside.

One of the greatest curiosities on San Nicolas, after all, is the wind. It tosses the sand dunes into the air like wraiths, and keeps them continually moving and shifting. It has buried a stone house and so threatened another that the lone herder on the island often deserts it for shelter among the rocks near the sea-lion rookeries, fearing that it will be blown into the sea. For two successive years the writer, as guest of Commodore Burnham, of the Santa Catalina Yacht Club, made the attempt to reach this inhospitable island. The first time the yacht was blown away; the second the party was able to land, but owing to the terrific wind was glad to leave. Approaching the island presented a flat and barren appearance, and the yacht finally came to under the lee of strange cliffs that rise from the sea, while to the north a long spit of sand extends to the east. In some places the cliff is worn by the combined forces of water and wind into marvellous shapes, and is everywhere difficult of ascent. Some sailors have a superstition that the strange wind that blows from the island is from the souls of the natives, who resent this intrusion and the robbing of their graves.

The yacht's party soon had an experience with the wind. A black fog cloud came sweeping down over the island and the wind blew a hurricane, dissipating the fog and blowing until 2 o'clock in the morning. The landing was made in a heavy sea—a dangerous operation. The single inhabitant, a French herder, was standing on the sands, looking a typical Robinson Crusoe. He had a big hat, strapped on under his chin, an old-fashioned shot gun over his shoulder, a cane in his other hand. Two half-breed shepherd dogs crouched near him. He evidenced no desire to hear from the outer world; his one wish was for beans, which, unfortunately, could not be gratified. He had a small fortune at hand in the antiquities which he could pick up; but he was undoubtedly loath to despoil the graves, though not averse to pointing out the skeletons which had been uncovered here and there. Everywhere the wonderful evidences of the wind were apparent. In one canyon the writer photographed a section that seemed to have almost been carved by Titanic hands. There were great faces, impossible forms of animals, delicate lacelike tracery, all creating a weird effect.

The island seemed to be in the grasp of innumerable sand glaciers, which, instead of moving down, moved up, and were ever shifting in the wind. The canyon in which the so-called wild woman is supposed to have lived is visible. A more deserted spot it is difficult to imagine—a river of sand winding up from the distant sea and covering everything. Here and there rise strange tree-like shapes that resemble the trunks of spectral trees, and which but add to the weirdness of the scene. Everywhere were evidences of former occupation. Some of the party dug into the mounds, where curious stone slabs marked perhaps the graves of the ancestors of the wild woman. Pearl fishhooks, bone pipes, and a flint spearhead were found, standing possibly just where they had been left; and tons of implements have been taken from the surface of the sand dunes. In one canyon a remarkable drapery of sandstone is being worn out by the wind. In others caves were found, one with strange hieroglyphics painted on the stone.

Everything here tells of desolation and death; the sands strewn with the bones of a lost race, the deep canyons filling up with the deadly sand that conceals the remains of unnumbered people who lived here in the past. The wind does not always blow at San Nicolas. The summer is the season of winds; in winter days and weeks follow when the island is at peace and the sand dunes seem sleeping. But fierce winter storms come suddenly, and the island is not in good favour among the navigators of the Pacific.

FAMILY MONOPOLIES.

PEOPLE BORN TO WRITE SHORT-HAND AND CHOP OFF HEADS.

Any child bearing the patronymic of Gurney, and numbering among his ancestors one Thomas Gurney, of short-hand fame, need never starve. There is a ready-made career awaiting him.

In 1750 Thomas Gurney published a system of stenography, and a few years later got the British Government to accept it as the official system. Since that date to the present day his descendants have been the official reporters in both Houses of Parliament. Indeed, no other system is used in the Upper House.

Take a dictionary and look up the scent called eau-de-Cologne. You will find that it is "a perfume made by distillation from certain essential oils with rectified spirit," and with that rather ambiguous definition you must be content, for no dictionary-maker has ever known what eau-de-Cologne is made of.

It is now more than a hundred years ago since one Count de Farina, a citizen of the German town of Cologne, discovered by chance the way to make this perfume, and since that date up to the present the secret of the Farina eau-de-Cologne has never been allowed to leak out of the Farina family. Of course there are other makers of eau-de-Cologne, but not the Farina scent.

Every Friday morning since the reign of George the First, prior to the railway, a specially-guarded coach, and, for the last 70 years, a specially guarded and constructed railway-van, has left the little village of Laverstoke, in Hampshire, loaded with specially-made paper. This is the famous Bank of England note-paper, which has been made by the Portal family, and them only, for more than four generations.

This paper is made from unruled linen, and has to be of such strength that each banknote is tested by hanging from it a 30lb weight.

The special method of manufacture has been rightly kept a secret, as up to the present the failure of forgers to correctly copy the paper has saved the bank many millions. This is the reason why every consignment is so carefully guarded that, should any one slip go astray, the directors could put their hands on the responsible man without hesitation.

In 1787, one Richard Crawshaw, the son of a small Yorkshire farmer, was earning a mere living by making bar iron in the then approved way. Early in the present century he acquired a new method of puddling, as the moulding of iron ore is called, and up to the present day the Crawshays have kept this method a strict family secret. Soon after they had acquired the patent they were appointed ironmakers to the British Navy, a post they held to-day. And one need only remember the saying of one of our greatest admirals to see how esteemed the Crawshaw metal is by those who know its worth. "So long as the Crawshays keep their secret from the world, the British Navy will be world-famous."

For over 290 years the post of public executioner in France was the monopoly of the Sanson family. The progenitor came to France in 1547 in the retinue of Catherine de Medici, of Florentine fame. As a reward for good service Catherine gave her servant Sanson the post of public executioner, and decreed that it should be his descendants' by right of birth.

In 1840 the male line died out. Up to 1792 they used the axe; but then, with the dawn of the French Revolution, came the guillotine, and the Sanson then acting officially holds an undisputed, if not envied, record. He ended the lives of Louis XVI and his Queen, Marie Antoinette, the Duc d'Orleans, Robespierre, Danton, and, in the crowd, most of the aristocracy of France and their enemies, the leaders of the Revolution.

"Come, monsieur," was the common remark among the aristocrats awaiting the guillotine, "do not keep Monsieur Sanson waiting; he has much to do to-day besides attending to your wants!"

Indeed, the "criminals" came in such large numbers that on more than one occasion Sanson almost fainted, and the Republican leaders had to call in other means of ridding themselves of their prisoners.

Whisper the word "Veneatchellum" in the ear of any Anglo-Indian, and, never mind how tired he may be, he will spring round, and, facing you, ask "Where?"

Veneatchellum is not the name of a great native prince, or anything to do with the army or civil service, but probably Veneatchellum has done more to make India popular with Englishmen than either, for the Veneatchellum family is among the oldest in the town of Madras, and from time immemorial it has manufactured a special kind of chutney and curry-powder, the like of which is made by none other, for its preparation is a family secret.

You cannot be Grand Almoner to her Majesty, because than post is the hereditary right of the Marquis of Exeter; nor Grand Falconer to the Queen, because the post belongs for the same reason to the Duke of St. Albans; nor yet Earl Marshal, as that office goes with the title of Duke of Norfolk. And these families have just as much a monopoly of these posts as the Guelph family has of the British Throne.

In some cases Royalty has extended its patronage to other families than noble ones for generations together.

The name of Messrs Eyre and Spottiswoode, the Royal printers, is familiar in the mouths of all. The firm was started as long ago as 1730, though the Spottiswoodes did not come into it till about 40 years later. Before that it was Strahan and Eyre. The Spottiswoodes have used their riches they have made well and wisely.

Science owes much to William Spottiswoode, who was head of the Royal Society and a member of the curious Letter X Club, which met at St. George's Hotel, and had only nine members, including Lubbock, Tyndall, Huxley, and Spencer.

You can hardly imagine a monopoly in such a business as that of banking. Yet it is a fact that the Gurneys, who founded the great house of Overend, Gurney, and Co., had a practical monopoly of the banking business in the Eastern Counties for many decades. Henry and John Gurney founded the Norwich Bank in 1770, and at one time its credit was better than that of the Bank of England itself. The family of Gurney have been connected with it for over 150 years.

Special brands of the beer dear to the British workman have long been sources of great riches to certain families. Bass Burton ale, for instance, has been a family possession for over a century. No other ale could imitate it for a number of years. William Bass, founder of the house, was a carrier. Now the works cover 145 acres, and turn out annually a million barrels of beer.

Amongst the many other trade secrets which have enriched successive generations of one family, mention must be made of Minton china and earthenware. The works were started at Stoke-on-Trent in 1793 by Thomas Minton. But it was his son Herbert who, early in the present century, secured from Dresden a valuable secret which greatly enhanced the value of the product. This was further improved by the securing, later on, of the wonderful dull-green glaze for which Minton ware is so well known. Four generations of Mintons have held the secrets of Minton ware.

To give some idea of the extent of their works, it may be mentioned that they use in one year 60,000 tons of blue clay, 40,000 of flint, and 15,000 of Cornish clay.

A PRIMITIVE CONGOLESE TRIBE: THE MAN-EATING N'SAKKARAS.

(B. COLT DE WOLF, in the Englishwoman.)

A trip to the Congo Free State is as easily accomplished now as is a Cook's tour through Egypt or Palestine. A voyage from Antwerp to Banana is, to-day, hardly more remarkable a performance than a journey from Liverpool to New York.

We had sailed from Antwerp in company with a number of Belgian officials—army officers, engineers, and others—on the good ship Albertville, one of those splendidly appointed vessels of Messrs Elder, Dempster, and Co.'s fleet. The voyage to Banana was a lengthy one, and the tropic heat at times intense, but the geniality of the captain, the general sociability of the passengers, and the comfort afforded on board went far to alleviate any monotony of prolonged sea travelling. On our arrival at Banana, we directed our steps towards the district of the Oubanghi, where live the most curious of Congolese natives, the N'Sakkaras, whose chief is the famous Bangasson, to whom the Belgians have given the title of Sultan. The N'Sakkaras are scattered along the territories comprised between the Koto and the Bali, on the right bank of the Oubanghi. We were not able to ascertain, even approximately, the number of these N'Sakkaras. But from the information we gathered there must be more than 25,000 of them. The women of the tribe are far more numerous than the men, owing to the slave trade, and the constant sale of male adults and boys. With the exception of hunting and dancing, the men do but little work, and leave all manual labour for the women, who, though locked upon as slaves are generally well treated. It is the women who cultivate the maize fields and sweet potato plantations.

The N'Sakkaras women are also the brewers of the tribe, and make a kind of beer out of the eleusine and sorgho, two varieties of native hops. This beer is the favourite drink of the N'Sakkaras. As for the favourite food of the men it is human flesh! All their enemies killed in battle, or members of their own tribe beheaded by order of the Sultan, are invariably eaten. As for the flesh of Europeans, which they rarely have the opportunity to indulge in, it is considered an exquisite dish by the N'Sakkaras. The women are, as a rule, not allowed to be present at these cannibal feasts, though it is they who invariably act as cooks in preparing human flesh.

The N'Sakkaras have a great partiality for the flesh of women and children, which is only partaken of on very solemn occasions, such as the marriage of a son or daughter of a chief, or after the conclusion of a treaty of peace with a powerful neighbouring tribe. Apropos of cannibalism, it would be a mistake to suppose that the man-eating tribes of the Congo are more ferocious in appearance than other African savages. All the N'Sakkaras whom we had occasion to come into contact with were peaceable and amiable, with none of the exterior characteristics which are popularly supposed to belong to cannibals. Unlike most other Congolese tribes, the N'Sakkaras have a rudimentary form of organised Government, with an army under the command of a single chief, the Sultan Bangasson. All the able-bodied unmarried men are enrolled in the Sultan's army. The elite of this army, some three hundred in number, form Bangasson's body-guard. They are attired like the French Senegalese, that is to say, they wear wide trousers (much the same shape as the up-to-date woman's bloomers) of cotton, with a shirt of the same material, pulled in by a cloth belt at the waist. The Sultan's body-guard alone wear this dress, the costume of the rank and file of the army being of a most elementary description.

When a chief is taken ill, before calling in the medicine men certain precautions are taken. All noise is stopped in the neighbourhood of the chief's cabin, no singing, no music being allowed. Then it is first attempted to determine who is responsible for the chief's illness, it being taken for granted that some member of his entourage has poisoned him. All the inhabitants of the village are then called together, the slaves being placed in a semi-circle, and the chief himself designates the two whom he considers guilty. The poor wretches are then put through the test of the joua, an instrument consisting of two wooden discs, which are soaked in water and then placed together. The decision depends upon the adherence or non-adherence of the two discs. If they adhere to each other the slave is accused of having poisoned the chief. As he invariably denies the crime, whether innocent or not, a chicken is then put through the test of poison. If the chicken survives the accused is pronounced innocent, but if it succumbs, he is at once put to death and his body eaten by the men present at the trial.

THE RECORD "ENDLESS CHAIN."

WHAT IT DID FOR ITS ORIGINATOR.

There is a young lady, Miss Nathalie Schenck by name, residing at Babylon, Long Island, some 36 miles from New York, who, 18 months ago, started an endless chain, as she will doubtless remember to the end of her days.

A patriotic damsel, this fair daughter of the Stars and Stripes conceived the happy idea of raising sufficient funds to buy an ice plant—that is, machinery for making ice—for the American soldiers then operating in Cuba.

Accordingly she sat down and wrote four apparently innocent epistles to as many school friends, explaining her project and asking each for a dime—a coin of about the value of 5d. She also asked each to induce four friends to write her and send her a dime, and thus was the "endless chain" started.

Very soon the responses commenced to pour in, growing in volume day by day. In a short time sufficient dimes came to hand to pay for the ice plant, which cost \$800. It was duly forwarded to Cuba,

and was used by the soldiers until the end of the war.

But letters continued to arrive in shoals, and the young lady's parents, became alarmed at the amazing growth of their daughter's endless chain. They made desperate efforts to stop it, but all in vain; letters came pouring in, in thousands, long after the war had ceased.

As many as 15,000 arrived in a single day, some from such distant countries as England, France, Italy, and some from South American towns. At first the missives were opened in a room in the house, but very soon this would not even hold them, and recourse was had to a spacious barn.

For upwards of 12 months this outbuilding was a bank and post office combined, Miss Schenck employing no fewer than 20 girls to go through the letters and take out the coins. The postmaster of Babylon found it necessary to engage an extra hand, an additional man was put on the train, and the local bank was obliged to obtain help—all on account of the endless chain.

But like all things, the chain finally came to an end, and at last there was a day when no letter arrived at the post office for Miss Schenck, much to that young lady's relief.

Altogether she received upwards of a quarter of a million letters, or enough to fill 32 barrels. The dimes enclosed in them were of the total value of \$5000, and arranged in a single column, they would tower to a height of 800ft in the air.

The chain only broke when the record was completely shattered; and if the author could have foreseen the sensation it created, and the notoriety it brought her, she would have hesitated to set it going.

In the streets people stared at her so much that she disliked to go out, and her relatives became so nervous that they employed a watchman to guard the house.

Miss Schenck was made by her endless chain the most popular girl in New York, as testified by the numerous songs and poems of which she has been made the subject.

Moreover, it has been the cause of her receiving several offers of marriage, which were sent to her through the post by men who had never seen her, but had read of her sensational chain in the newspapers.

Being only a girl of 15, she was rather alarmed by the receipt of these proposals, which made her wish she had never started her endless chain. In order that she might escape the notoriety which it brought upon her, her grandfather sent her on a trip to Europe; and no doubt by the time she returns home some other sensation will have caused hers to be forgotten.

ANIMAL LURES.

W. E. CRAW, in the Popular Science Monthly (U.S.).

It is a pretty well known fact among hunters and students of Nature generally, that most flesh-eating animals, whether in fur or feathers, can be more readily called by imitating the squeaking of mice than in any other way, and proves conclusively enough that these creatures depend largely on the sense of hearing in their struggle for a livelihood.

My first practical illustration of this fact occurred so long ago that it seems almost like ancient history. For some reason or other one summer's vacation began some six hours earlier than was expected, and although apparently insignificant enough when compared with the entire three months that were to follow, that extra half-holiday was probably valued out of all due proportion by the pupils, owing to its unexpectedness, and for that reason, perhaps, more than any other, is still recalled by one at least as distinctly as ever. One of the boys had a contrivance known as a bird-call—a simple instrument of wood and some soft metal—that, on being turned produced noises that bore not the slightest resemblance to the cries of any bird, but were not entirely unlike the squeaking of a mouse in distress. Some of us were more or less sceptical as to its powers of attracting birds, and decided to put it to the test. So we loafed about under the apple trees "working" the thing for all it was worth, but no birds came about us, and the bird-call was in danger of being thrown away in disgrace, when a small brown beast appeared from under a pile of boards and came running towards us, till suddenly scenting danger it disappeared. There was some discussion at the time whether it was a rat, chipmunk, or red squirrel; none had seen it very clearly or could give any very definite description of it, but in all probability it was a weasel, attracted by what it supposed to be the voice of its accustomed prey.

About half-way between that time and the present a young long-eared owl became an important member of our family, a most original and amusing bird, without the slightest fear of any of us. He was christened Mephistopheles. As he was learning to fly, it seemed advisable that he should be taught to come at our call to be fed; and accordingly one day, by way of experiment, I held out a piece of meat to him and squeaked like a mouse. There was a rush of downy pinions, and his talons were neatly arranged about my lips. He was evidently a good deal excited, but was careful not to hurt me any more than was absolutely necessary in order to secure the mouse which he fancied he had cornered in my mouth. I was just reckless enough to try it again on the following day as he perched on the low branch of an apple tree. His power of detecting the direction whence the sound came proved fully equal to the occasion, and the result was the same as in the first instance. The end of Mephistopheles was tragic in the extreme. He was sometimes fastened by a linen cord six or eight feet long, and as large as a lead pencil, which when not in use was hung across the perch where he slept. Evidently he felt that the food furnished him was too effeminate, for the powerful stomachs of all birds of prey require a certain amount of such indigestible matter as hair, feathers, or bone to keep them in good condition. So one ill-fated night, in looking about for something that would

THE WIND-SWEPT ISLAND OF SAN NICOLAS.

PROFESSOR C. F. HOLDER, in the Scientific American.

About seventy miles off the coast of Southern California lies the island of San Nicolas—a veritable desert, wind-swept to such a degree that one might well imagine the furies are guarding the island. San Nicolas, which is 12 miles long and four or five wide, has no harbours, the anchorage being merely a lee under the low hills; the fact that the wind blows directly off-shore making it possible for vessels to anchor here at certain seasons. On this island, which has been the central point of a romance and tragedy of much interest, deserted and alone, Maria Better Than Nothing, the wild woman of San Nicolas, lived 20 years—long enough to forget her people and even her language. The story is as follows:—

For centuries the island was inhabited by

follows:—

For centuries the island was inhabited by a race of hardy mariners who have left their monuments in large shell heaps and mounds that cover many acres. Less than one hundred years ago, the Franciscan fathers determined to take the natives away from the inhospitable island and provide them with homes around the various missions, where they could also be comfortably converted. With this object in view, a vessel was sent to the island, and after much difficulty the Indians, now reduced to about one hundred, were collected and taken aboard, deserting thousands of implements which their ancestors had used for centuries. When the vessel was about to sail, one of the women discovered that her child had been left behind. But it was blowing a gale, and the vessel could not hold, so the captain sailed away, whereupon the frantic mother dashed into the sea and swam back to the shore, making her way successfully through the surf. The captain of the vessel promised to return for the woman, but soon after his vessel was wrecked, and no attempt was made to rescue the poor Indian woman until 20 years after, when a priest determined to make an effort to learn whether she was alive. He enlisted the services of an otter hunter and several Indians, who in a small schooner, known as *Better Than Nothing*, set sail for San Nicolas.

They landed on the island, and very soon

set sail for San Nicolas.

They landed on the island, and very soon found evidence that some one was living there, but avoiding them. To make the search perfect, the men formed a line across the island at certain distances apart, which resulted in the discovery of the wild woman. She was sitting by a brush hut in a canyon, about which was a windbreak of whalebones and various material. She smiled and spoke to the Indians in a language they did not understand; but they fell on their faces before her as though to worship her. She offered them food, and readily consented to go with them, and was taken aboard the schooner with a tame otter. She was dressed in the skins of birds, over which was a garment of seal-skin. She was named Better Than Nothing, after the vessel, and by signs succeeded in telling some Indians on the mainland something of her history. At first she had mourned the loss of her friends; then the dogs killed her baby, and she wished to die and was sick for a long time. She was taken to Santa Barbara, where Indians from all about were brought to her to see if they could understand her language, but without avail. She lived with different families at Santa Barbara; but civilisation proved disastrous to her, and in less than three months she died. Her remarkable dress of feathers was sent to Rome as a curiosity, and the remains of the unfortunate woman found a resting-place in the sanctified ground of the mission.

San Nicolas has proved a veritable trea-

sure-house for the archæologist, and tons of stone implements have been taken from various mounds on the island. One of the most remarkable shell mounds in the world is found here, being, it is said, nearly a mile long and ten feet in average height. On its wind-swept surface innumerable objects have been found, exposed during previous hurricanes, with the bodies of Indians facing each other, having been buried in a sitting position, with hands clasped over the head. With many remains were buried such personal effect as mortars, ollas, flutes, jewel boxes, charms, flint spear-heads, and almost every article needed by a hunting and fishing people—all formed from shell, bone, or wood. Fishing lines were made of kelp; sinkers of stone with a groove worn around or a hole in the centre; the hook was of elegant design, and bore the barb upon the outside.

One of the greatest curiosities on San Nicolas, after all, is the wind. It tosses the sand dunes into the air like wraiths, and keeps them continually moving and shifting. It has buried a stone house and so threatened another that the lone herder on the island often deserts it for shelter among the rocks near the sea-lion rookeries, fearing that it will be blown into the sea. For two successive years the writer, as guest of Commodore Burnham, of the Santa Catalina Yacht Club, made the attempt to reach this inhospitable island. The first time the yacht was blown away; the second the party was able to land, but owing to the terrific wind was glad to leave. Approaching the island presented a flat and barren appearance, and the yacht finally came to under the lee of strange cliffs that rise from the sea, while to the north a long spit of sand extends to the east. In some places the cliff is worn by the combined forces of water and wind into marvellous

places the cliff is worn by the combined forces of water and wind into marvellous shapes, and is everywhere difficult of ascent. Some sailors have a superstition that the strange wind that blows from the island is from the souls of the natives, who resent this intrusion and the robbing of their graves.

The yacht's party soon had an experience with the wind. A black fog cloud came sweeping down over the island and the wind blew a hurricane, dissipating the fog and blowing until 2 o'clock in the morning. The landing was made in a heavy sea—a dangerous operation. The single inhabitant, a French herder, was standing on the sands, looking a typical Robinson Crusoe. He had a big hat strapped on under his chin, an old-fashioned shot gun over his shoulder, a cane in his other hand. Two half-breed shepherd dogs crouched near him. He evidenced no desire to hear from the outer world; his one wish was for beans, which, unfortunately, could not be gratified. He had a small fortune at hand in the antiquities which he could pick up; but he was undoubtedly loath to despoil the graves, though not averse to pointing out the skeletons which had been uncovered here and there. Everywhere the wonderful evidences of the wind were apparent. In one canyon the writer photographed a section that seemed to have almost been carved by Titanic hands. There were great faces, impossible forms of animals, delicate lacelike tracery, all creating a weird effect. . . .

The island seemed to be in the grasp of innumerable sand glaciers which instead

The island seemed to be in the grasp of innumerable sand glaciers, which, instead of moving down, moved up, and were ever shifting in the wind. The canyon in which the so-called wild woman is supposed to have lived is visible. A more deserted spot it is difficult to imagine—a river of sand winding up from the distant sea and covering everything. Here and there rise strange tree-like shapes that resemble the trunks of spectral trees, and which but add to the weirdness of the scene. Everywhere were evidences of former occupation. Some of the party dug into the mounds, where curious stone slabs marked perhaps the graves of the ancestors of the wild woman. Pearl fishhooks, bone pipes, and a flint spearhead were found, standing possibly just where they had been left; and tons of implements have been taken from the surface of the sand dunes. In one canyon a remarkable drapery of sandstone is being worn out by the wind. In others caves were found, one with strange hieroglyphics painted on the stone.

Everything here tells of desolation and death; the sands strewn with the bones of a lost race, the deep canyons filling up with the deadly sand that conceals the remains of unnumbered people who lived here in the past. The wind does not always blow at San Nicolas. The summer is the season of winds; in winter days and weeks follow when the island is at peace and the sand dunes seem sleeping. But fierce winter storms come suddenly, and the island is not in good favour among the navigators of the Pacific.